PRE-SEED · 2026

Helm

The operations autopilot for independent e-commerce brands.

COMPANY

Why now

Agentic AI finally makes reliable, low-cost operations automation possible, while a record number of solo founders are launching stores without back-office staff.

03

PRODUCT

The problem

Independent online stores lose 12+ hours a week on inventory, fulfillment, and support across disconnected tools. 90% of brands under $2M can't afford an ops manager.

04

PRODUCT

What it is

Helm is an AI operations layer that connects a store's existing tools and runs repetitive work autonomously — with a human-in-the-loop dashboard.

05

COMPANY

Business model

Tiered SaaS from $79–$399 / month based on order volume, plus usage fees on automated actions. Land at solo-founder tier, expand as brands scale.

06

MARKET

Market opportunity

TAM
$48B · global SMB e-commerce ops

SAM
$6.2B · English-speaking DTC

SOM
$310M · 3-year reachable

07

PRODUCT

Traction

1,400 brands on the waitlist · $18K MRR from pilot cohort · 9% week-over-week growth · 62 NPS across pilots.

08

PEOPLE

Why this team

CEO
8 years scaling DTC operations, ex-Shopify Plus.

CTO
Former ML lead, two prior exits in workflow automation.

09

PRODUCT

Roadmap · 12 months

Deep Shopify integration → multi-platform → enterprise pilots. Each milestone unlocks the next tier of automation and ACV expansion.

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FINANCE

Use of funds

Engineering & integrations (50%) · GTM & partnerships (30%) · ops runway (20%). Target: 5,000 paying brands and $1M ARR in 18 months.

FINANCE · THE ASK

Raising $1.5M pre-seed

Capital allocated to engineering, integrations, and go-to-market to reach 5,000 paying brands and $1M ARR over 18 months.

THANK YOU

Let's build the future.

hello@helm.app · helm.app